

Datadog, Inc.

NY Bus Tour Takeaways

DDOG reiterated confidence in AI and non-AI workload growth driven by consolidation, platform expansion, and competitive differentiation. LLM observability, SIEM, and logs serve as key value drivers for expansion oppty.

We hosted David Obstler (CFO) and Yuka Broderick (Head of Investor Relations).

Key Takeaway: We were encouraged by mgmt reiterating strength in its non-AI workload growth, anchored by four key pillars: cloud migrations, SKU expansion, consolidation from other vendors, and its GTM evolution (quota capacity, channel, partnerships, etc). Further, mgmt argued that its pricing structure is well supported by near-100% enterprise retention, high-90s SMB retention, limited reliance on very large customers, and competitive differentiation (customer consolidation oppty). DDOG also discussed the traction that its MCP Server has seen as it extends its platform into agentic AI workflows (this will eventually be monetized over time, similarly to the rest of DDOG's consumption-based pricing).

- **DDOG's growth supported by consolidation and growth in production workloads.** Most of the 600+ AI-native customers started on homegrown, open-source, commercial, and hyperscaler monitoring solutions and consolidated onto DDOG. AI workloads look operationally similar to other cloud-native production workloads, with the main difference being faster growth rates. DDOG does not participate in model training but instead scales alongside inference and production demand.
- **Treating native-AI companies similar to the rest of its customer base.** DDOG views its native-AI customer base in the same way as cloud-native customers, using the same geographic and sales structure. Early-stage companies typically enter through Datadog for Startups with free offerings, and as they scale the company focuses on usage transparency, optimization, cross-sell, and broader platform adoption. Larger enterprises are routed to enterprise sales and smaller customers to commercial or mid-market teams.
- **MCP Server is built to support agentic workflows, and DDOG plans to monetize this capability over time.** DDOG's MCP Server ingests more than just metrics as it captures production data, coding tools, and end-to-end software production workflows. Monetization will follow Datadog's standard consumption-based model similar to databases, networks, cloud, and LLMs (though pricing details have not yet been released). DDOG highlighted the rapid adoption it has seen with MCP connector volume up 11x (see Fig below). In a recent blog post (see [here](#)), DDOG laid out how its MCP Server extends its unified observability platform directly into AI workflows.

DDOG	OVERWEIGHT
U.S. Software	POSITIVE
Price Target	USD 165.00
Price (11-Mar-26)	USD 127.49
Potential Upside/Downside	+29.4%
Source: Bloomberg, Barclays Research	

U.S. Software

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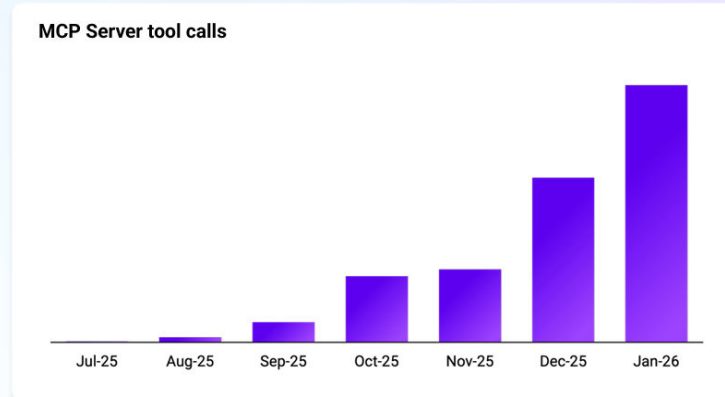
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FIGURE 1. DDOG plans to monetize its MCP Server over time and has seen rapid adoption of the capability over the last 6 months.

Datadog MCP Server usage is growing exponentially



Source: DDOG 2026 Investor Day

- DDOG's pricing is grounded in value provided to customers and backed by continued strong gross retention trends.** Mgmt pushed back on price-sensitivity concerns, noting high gross retention (enterprise retention near 100% and SMB around high 90%) and limited concentration to large customers (noting only 34 customers with >\$10mil ARR). The company also highlighted that DDOG is cheap relative to doing it yourself, and competitors that have tried to undercut on price have historically failed (given gap in functionality). Mgmt also believes that cutting price would only reduce revenue without truly changing outcomes.
- Self-managed cloud deployments not distracting away from the true focus on building public / private cloud architecture.** DDOG highlighted that these deployments are driven by data residency or compliance requirements and not a desire to get rid of cloud architectures. The company's control-plane approach allows its customers to keep data in their own environments while still leveraging Datadog's full platform. Mgmt stressed that public cloud migrations remain healthy and that true on-prem usage is not meaningfully re-accelerating. Datadog has a flexible approach to deployment models, though continues to believe that cloud is the dominant long-term trend.

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Datadog, Inc. (DDOG, 11-Mar-2026, USD 127.49), Overweight/Positive, CE/J

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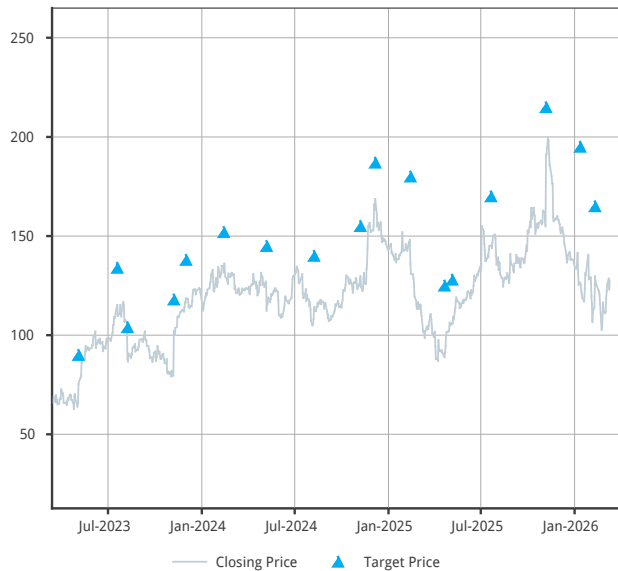
Stock Rating: **OVERWEIGHT**

Industry View: **POSITIVE**

Closing Price: **USD 127.49** (11-Mar-2026)

Rating and Price Target Chart - USD (as of 11-Mar-2026)

Currency=USD



Source: IDC, Barclays Research

[Link to Barclays Live for interactive charting](#)

Publication Date	Closing Price*	Rating	Adjusted Price Target
10-Feb-2026	114.01		165.00
12-Jan-2026	125.49		195.00
06-Nov-2025	190.82		215.00
21-Jul-2025	145.02		170.00
06-May-2025	105.70		128.00
21-Apr-2025	91.18		125.00
13-Feb-2025	135.89		180.00
06-Dec-2024	163.35		187.00
07-Nov-2024	129.79		155.00
08-Aug-2024	105.47		140.00
07-May-2024	126.97		145.00
13-Feb-2024	134.85		152.00
01-Dec-2023	116.57		138.00
07-Nov-2023	79.55		118.00
08-Aug-2023	106.30		104.00
19-Jul-2023	113.82		134.00
04-May-2023	75.40		90.00

On 11-Mar-2023, prior to any intra-day change that may have been published, the rating for this security was Overweight, and the adjusted price target was 95.00.

Source: Bloomberg, Barclays Research

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